

Chapter 177-4

After thinking, the system answered in a way humans could understand: 【Because someone's voice was heard by the gods, the gods granted you fortune, but also brought you misfortune. Everyone is subject to the laws and regulations within their dimensional world, but only those who have been chosen are subject to interstellar constraints.】

Liang Shi: "..."

So she and the original host were the humans whose voices had been heard by the gods.

Indeed.

She had once wished for lots and lots of love.

Then what about the original host?

Lots and lots of money?

This was just Liang Shi's guess.

With the mindset that she wouldn't have anything to do with the system after this matter was resolved, Liang Shi asked the system directly: "Can you tell me what voices of ours were heard by the gods?"

At this point, the system no longer concealed anything and transmitted a sequence of images into her mind.

The images contained not only her childhood, not only the wishes she made every year.

There was also another person's childhood.

That person had the same face as her. Her father was mute, and her mother had a long scar on her face, so she always wore a veil to cover it.

They were the poorest family in the village, and she was always mocked at school for dressing plainly and living in the worst house in the village.

Her greatest wish was to have money and to live in a new house.

When she learned that she could make wishes on her birthday, she made several wishes.

"I hope Dad can speak."

"I hope Mom's face gets better."

"I hope Grandpa's legs don't hurt on rainy days."

"I hope Grandma doesn't have to work so hard."

In her seventh year, her parents went out shopping on her birthday, only to tragically encounter a car accident.

She became an orphan from then on.

Her status as an orphan didn't earn her any special treatment either—she was still the isolated one in class.

She would go to school on time and return home on time with her backpack after school.

But on the way, she would hear people calling her: "Jinx! Bad luck charm!"¹

Her family received 200,000 yuan in compensation from her parents' car accident.

On the day she couldn't help but get into a fight with her classmates, her grandparents discussed moving away.

They moved to another village closer to town and built a new house.

And in her eighth year, she made a wish while crying in front of birthday candles.

She said: "I want lots and lots of money."

And so, her wish was heard by the gods.

She and she exchanged places.

One received money, one received love.

And all their terrible memories from before were erased, allowing them to start anew.

This was the gods' favor to them.

But little did they know, it was also the beginning of other nightmares.

This was the original host's story.

When Liang Shi watched this sequence of images, her eyes welled up with tears several times.

After watching, her entire heart felt like something was stuffed inside it—an aching, tingling soreness.

Liang Shi asked the system with a choked voice: 【So why was it us? Life was already hard enough.】

The system was silent for a moment. Liang Shi wasn't sure if it was her imagination, but that mechanical voice seemed to carry a hint of human hesitation at this moment: 【Many things have no why. It can only be said that it's you.】

Just like how people always wonder: Why me?

Why did things turn out this way?

Why is my life so terrible?

Why can't I have both money and love?

Why do I have to suffer so much?

So often, the most powerless feeling comes from: there is no why.

Because it's your life.

Some people's lives shine brightly, but some people never have a single ray of light shine into their entire lives.

The original host's life was like this, and Liang Shi's life nearly was too.

Fortunately, they were working hard.

Working hard to run toward the distance.

Working hard to let the light in.

Since they were powerless to ask why, they could only struggle to change themselves.

That night when Liang Shi went to sleep holding Xu Qingzhu, she suddenly said with deep emotion: "Thank you."

Xu Qingzhu was confused and touched her face. "What's wrong with my Teacher Liang now? Looking so pitiful, and even crying."

Xu Qingzhu leaned in and kissed her. "Did you watch some TV drama again?"

Liang Shi shook her head. "It's more tragic than any TV drama."

She thought for a moment and still told Xu Qingzhu about the original host's story.

Because although she had never met the parents from that side, from their photos together, they seemed like two very kind people, just like her grandpa and grandma.

If they were still alive, they would have given Liang Shi lots of love too.

Xu Qingzhu was also silent for a while after hearing this.

Liang Shi hugged her, feeling aggrieved and pitiful. "So that's why I want to thank you. You're the one who let light shine into my life."

But Xu Qingzhu lay flat, her fingers sliding between Liang Shi's fingers, interlocking with hers. "That's not true. You took care of me first."

Xu Qingzhu said: "If it weren't for you back then, I might have died in that kidnapping case."

Liang Shi paused briefly. "Speaking of which, I should also thank Qi Jiao. If it weren't for her, I wouldn't have been so strong either."

But speaking of Qi Jiao was another sad matter.

Liang Shi placed her hand on Xu Qingzhu's belly, as if covering the ears of the two little ones.

Liang Shi's voice was soft yet gentle as she said: "These things are more like snow falling on the world—each person has their own shadows and brightness."

Yang Jiani was like that, yet she raised a little angel like Qi Jiao.

And Qi Jiao was gentle and beautiful, so she met Chen Mian, who came to bring her light.

But Chen Mian didn't get to wait for her Qi Jiao to grow up.

Qi Jiao, who didn't get to grow up, went to another place. Living here in her place, enduring silently, was Gu Xingyue—stolen by human traffickers but then abandoned at an orphanage's doorstep.

The Gao family, whose family was destroyed because of the human traffickers, met with ruin—and Gu Xingyue killed her enemies with her own hands.

The original host attracted Zhou Yi'an, but because of this world's rules about Alphas not being able to be with other Alphas, or other reasons, they didn't end up together.

Zhou Yi'an kept chasing, but the original host's love for Xu Qingzhu turned to hatred, ultimately creating a tragedy.

The book followed its main plotline, while the people outside the main plot were also simultaneously experiencing their own lives.

Their joys and sorrows, loves and hatreds were all happening at the same time.

Footnotes:

¹ "Jinx! Bad luck charm!" - The original Chinese uses "災星" (zāixīng, disaster star) and "掃把星" (sàobǎxīng, broom star/comet). In Chinese folk belief, comets were considered bad omens, and people believed to bring bad luck to those around them were called these names. It's a cruel superstition often directed at orphans, implying they caused their parents' deaths.